

SENATE RESOLUTION 244

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kameron Whalum of Memphis.

WHEREAS, Kameron Whalum is a multifaceted musician whose warm trombone tone, soulful voice, and stage charisma have earned him a permanent place in pop culture's top echelon; and

WHEREAS, best known for his long-running role with Grammy-winning superstar Bruno Mars—and more recently as a founding member of Silk Sonic—Kameron embodies the sound and soul of contemporary R&B with roots that reach deep into the cultural bedrock of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, raised in a family that breathes music, Kameron is the youngest of three brothers (Kenneth and Kortland) and part of a musical dynasty that includes the iconic Kirk Whalum; music was never just a hobby—it was the fabric of daily life; and

WHEREAS, surrounded by singers, instrumentalists, and pastors, Kameron's love for music grew naturally, nurtured by Sunday services, school bands, and summer sessions at the Stax Music Academy; and

WHEREAS, a proud alumnus of Morehouse College, Kameron immersed himself in jazz band, marching band, and glee club before continuing his studies at the University of Memphis and eventually The New School for Jazz and Contemporary Music in New York City, New York; and

WHEREAS, it was in New York that his big break emerged—his brother Kenneth was asked to assemble a horn section for a Bruno Mars performance, and Kameron got the call;

what was supposed to be a one-night gig became a permanent role on world tours, award shows, and international stages; and

WHEREAS, from playing sold-out stadiums to collaborating in the studio on hits like "Leave the Door Open" with Silk Sonic, Kameron's musicianship is defined by soul, subtlety, and spiritual grounding; he brings not just technique, but heart, to every performance—always connecting to something deeper than the note itself; and

WHEREAS, Kameron is also deeply committed to mentorship and legacy-building. As an ambassador for Berklee's City Music program, he empowers young musicians to pursue their dreams, emphasizing self-belief, purpose, and cultural pride. "I want to show students that it's not a pipe dream," he says. "It's right there. If you believe, you've got to believe all the way"; and

WHEREAS, his reflections on Black history and Memphis music speak to his profound understanding of lineage and responsibility. Kameron honors those who paved the way—from his ancestors to his uncles—while carrying the torch forward with authenticity and gratitude. "We come from kings and queens," he says. "Now it's our turn";

WHEREAS, still evolving, Kameron continues to tour, record, and uplift the next generation—forever grounded in the Memphis soul that made him; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor Kameron Whalum, reflecting on his contributions to music and his enduring legacy of excellence and creativity.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.